

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Pull-Aside Meeting with President Franjo Tudjman of the Republic of Croatia (U)

PARTICIPANTS: U.S.
The President
Warren Christopher, Secretary of State
Anthony Lake, Assistant to the President for National Security Affairs
Richard Holbrooke, Assistant Secretary of State for European and Canadian Affairs
Alexander Vershbow, Senior Director for European Affairs, NSC Staff (Notetaker)

Croatia
Franjo Tudjman, President
Mate Granic, Minister of Foreign Affairs
Gojko Susak, Minister of Defense
Ambassador Miomir Zuzul, Special Envoy
Other Advisors

DATE, TIME December 14, 1995, 9:45-9:55 a.m.
AND PLACE: U.S. Ambassador's Residence, Paris, France

The President: I know how important implementation of the Eastern Slavonia settlement is for you. Let me say that if you hadn't shown restraint, the whole peace agreement would not have happened. We want to help on Eastern Slavonia. ~~(C)~~

President Tudjman: Mr. President, the report by Boutros-Ghali is terrible. He is playing games in proposing 9300-11,000 troops and stretching implementation over six months. It is important that you have appointed a retired General as civilian administrator. He can go ahead and begin the process now. ~~(C)~~

The President: He's a good man. ~~(C)~~

President Tudjman: You should try to get the Nordics to join the Belgian forces. ~~(C)~~

Richard Holbrooke: We agree that Boutros-Ghali's troop numbers are crazy. ~~(C)~~

President Tudjman: And six months is too long. ~~(C)~~

The President: I will work on this today. I will try to speak with Boutros-Ghali and get him to move. We can't wait. ~~(C)~~

President Tudjman: If new troops are needed, the Nordic battalion can be redeployed to Eastern Slavonia from Tuzla now that U.S. forces have arrived. That would only take a couple of days. ~~(C)~~

Secretary Christopher: We also wanted to exchange views with you on the importance that we and our Congress attach to the Federation. ~~(C)~~

The President: We won a big vote in the Senate yesterday. We managed to get a group of Republicans to vote with me. Many in Congress are saying that they are worried that the Federation will break up. I ask you to make sure that the Croats in the Federation work hard to strengthen the Federation. We will work to ensure that they are treated fairly. ~~(C)~~

President Tudjman: I am sure the Croats will do all they can to make the Federation work. You need to convince the Muslim leadership. For example, there need to be more Croats representing the Federation abroad. ~~(C)~~

The President: I agree. ~~(C)~~

-- End of Conversation --